

Understand Your Gender Pay Gap

UNDERSTAND YOUR GENDER PAY GAP

A practical step-by-step guide for employers

Your gender pay gap data helps you see where pay imbalance happens — and what to improve.

1) Check pay levels (pay quarters)

Review the gender split in:

- Upper
- Upper middle
- Lower middle
- Lower pay quarters

Also check departments, job types, and seniority levels.

2) Review promotions

At each stage, compare women and men:

- Applying
- Shortlisted/assessed
- Selected

If women drop out at any stage, senior-level imbalance may worsen.

3) Review recruitment

By level/grade, compare outcomes at:

- Application
- Shortlisting
- Selection

- Acceptance

Check if women are hired mainly into lower-paid roles.

4) Analyse exit rates

Compare women vs men leaving each grade annually.

If more women leave higher-paid grades, the pay gap can increase.

5) Check bonuses, overtime, and additional pay

For comparable work, compare:

- Bonus access and values
- Overtime opportunities and pay
- Unsociable-hours pay

6) Compare starting salaries

Review starting pay for women and men in similar roles.

If negotiation is allowed, check whether it creates unequal starting pay.

7) Review performance scores

Compare scores by gender, grade, and role.

If possible, separate self-ratings and manager ratings.

8) Assess part-time progression

Compare part-time vs full-time staff on:

- Promotion rates
- Performance outcomes
- Access to senior roles

9) Review support for caring responsibilities

Compare take-up by women and men of:

- Flexible working
- Shared Parental Leave
- Paternity leave

Use staff surveys to check culture and progression barriers.

Turn findings into action

For each issue, define:

- Action
- Owner
- Deadline
- Success measure

Track progress regularly (monthly/quarterly) using the same metrics.